

AN OUTLINE OF THE **HISTORY** OF
CHRISTIANITY

4-

at century :

Ca. 6 B.C. **Jesus** born

Ca. 30 A.D. Jesus **crucified**

Twelve

Apostles

.. 31 A.D. Paul converted

C4 A.D. Nero persecutes **Christians** in

Paul and Peter

martyred.

Rome

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Jesus **life** and **teachings**. Peter leads
the **early church** in Jerusalem. Early **Chris-
tian** missionary work. Paul, the
"Missionary **to** the Gentiles, carries out
extensive missionary work. **Most** of the
writings which **are** to become the **New**
Testament **are written**.

Second century :

Roman Empire persecutes :

under Trajan

(98-117)

under Marcus Aurelius

(161-180)

155 Polycarp Martyred

166 Martyrdom of Justin

Martyr Irenaeus (ca. 130-190)

writes in

defense of

Christianity.

7 century:

Clement of Alexandria

(died 213) Origen (185-251)

Decius persecutes (249-251)

St. Anthony (251-356) and
Monasticism Tertullian embraces
Montanism, ca. 207.

fourth century:

Diocletian persecutes (303-305)
212 Constantine becomes Emperor
313 The Edict of Milan, granting
tolerance to
Christianity. 325 Council of
Nicaea Constantine (296-337)
Jerome (347-420)
St. Ambrose of Milan (340-397)
320 Christianity decreed as
the
religion of the empire by Emperor
Theodosius.

fifth

century:

St. Augustine (354-430)
Pope Leo the Great (Pope 440-461) 451
Latin translation of the Bible
prepared by Jerome
418 Pelagius condemned
476 Rome falls to Alaric and
his
Visigoths.
529

Mystery religions and Gnosticism
compete
with Christianity.

New Testament canon generally fixed by
late

fourth century. Basic elements of Apostles' Creed formulated.

General spread of the faith in spite
of
sporadic persecution.

Writers like Origen and Tertullian

defend

Christianity with their pens.

Some Christians fall away because of persecution. Some received back into the Church.

Montanism, an **ascetic**, highly conservative sect, is an influence.

Doctrinal disputes **develop in** the Church, as with **Arianism and Donatism**. Cenobitic monasticism develops. **Bishops** are the leaders **of** the Church with the Bishop of Rome holding the greatest honor.

Roman **Emperors** begin to embrace the Christian

faith--starting **with** Constantine. Tensions begin to develop between the Church **in** the East and that **in** the West.

Armenian, **Syrian, Coptic, and** Nestorian Christians separate from the Church for political and doctrinal **reasons**. Barbarians invade the Empire in **the** West.

Evident signs of decay in the Roman Empire.

Missions into northern Europe.

Sixth century:

529 St. Benedict founds Monte Cassino and develops standard rule for monks.

Gregory the Great (Pope 590-604) restores order to Italy.

Clovis (466-511) King of the Franks

becomes a Christian.

596 Gregory sends Augustine as

missionary to
England.

Seventh century :

England converted to Christianity.

Empire in the West deteriorates.

Papacy under Gregory I needs to establish
secular
order.

Benedictine monks bring faith and culture to
many areas of Europe.

Tensions increase between East and West. Franks become the focus of power in the West.

Irish missionaries work in
Gaul.

Islam founded and Muslims come to control Palestine, **Egypt**, North Africa and move
into
Spain.

Eighth

century :

St. Boniface leads in the conversion of Germany. Charles Martel turns back the
Moslem advance at Tours in 732. Iconoclast controversy flares in the East. The
Pope becomes the ruler of sections of Italy. Charlemagne inherits the leadership
of the Franks.

Ninth

century :

Charlemagne becomes Holy Roman Emperor (800 to 814). Feudalism develops in
Europe
and in the Church. Tensions between Popes and Kings develop.
Scandinavian missions begin.

Tenth century :

The Dark Ages for Europe and the Church. Magyars from Asia and the Northmen
from

Scandinavia raid and plunder in Christian
Europe.

Conversion of Bohemians, Normans, Poles, Hungarians, and Russians. Secular
rulers dominate the Church. Benedictine monastery formed at Cluny.

Eleventh century:

Struggle for power between King Henry IV and Pope Gregory VII (Hildebrand) . Final break between Eastern Orthodoxy and Roman Catholicism in 1054. The Age of the Crusades begins.

Twelfth century:

Anselm of Canterbury (1033-1109)
Bernard of Clairvaux (1115-1153)
St. Francis of Assisi (1182-1226)

More crusades. General deterioration of moral standards in Church and State, while great men also appear on the scene. Some groups, as the Waldensians, seek reform, some rebel against the Church.

Thirteenth century:

Innocent III (Pope 1198-1216)
Thomas Aquinas (1225-1274)
Duns Scotus (1270-1308)

More crusades. Papacy reaches peak of power under Innocent III. King of England becomes vassal of Pope .
Inquisition. Great Gothic Cathedrals built.
Aquinas develops his great system of theology .

Fourteenth century:

General moral decay within the Church. Wycliffe seeks reform in England. Papacy exiled to Avignon. "Great Schism" within the Roman Catholic Church.

Fifteenth century:

Councils try, with little success, to reform the Church. John Huss burned as a heretic 1415. Renaissance develops .

Sixteenth century:

Martin Luther (1483-1546) -
John Calvin (1509-1564)

Ulrich Zwingli
(1484-1531)
Pope Paul III
(1534-1549)
Council of Trent
(1545-1563) 1521 Diet of
Worms
1530 Augsburg Confession

Seventeenth
century:

The century of the Protestant Reformation.

Nearly half of Europe breaks from
Roman Catholic Church. Groundwork and
development of the major Protestant
traditions. Roman Catholic "Counter-
Reformation" or the "Catholic
Reformation" takes place.

Puritans and Separatists develop in England.

These groups lead to founding of

"Pietism"
appears.

colonies in America. Quakers develop under
George Fox. 1643: The Westminster Confession of the
Presbyterians.

Eighteenth century:

The "Age of
Reason."

Religious revival movements in the
colonies.

John Wesley founds Methodism. Jonathan Edwards (1703-1758) the "greatest American
Theologian
."

Nineteenth
century:

The "Great Century" for the expansion of Christianity. World-wide
missions.

Salvation Army, Mormons, Christian Scientists, and Disciples

founded.

1869-1870: Vatican I. Dogma of Papal Infallibility
proclaimed.

Much of U.S. Protestantism splits over the slavery issue.

Twentieth century:

The "Ecumenical Movement" develops. The World Council of Churches is constituted
at Amsterdam in 1948.

1950

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The Dogma of the Assumption of the Virgin Mary
proclaimed. 1962: Second Vatican Council called by Pope John
XXIII.